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Ministry Gifts

Discover Your Design to Serve

Purpose

To help disciples discover how God has uniquely designed them to serve the Body of Christ through spiritual gifts, while ensuring their identity remains rooted in Christ—not in their function.

Why This Matters

Now it's time to discover HOW God wants to express His love through you. Spiritual gifts aren't about what makes you special—they're about how the Father equips you to serve others for the "common good" of the Body. This week, you'll discover your design and activate your gifts through impartation.

Preparation (Before the Meeting)

Leaders:

- **SEND THE SPIRITUAL GIFTS ASSESSMENT** to all disciples at least 3-4 days before the meeting (via DNA Group Dashboard)
- Review each disciple's assessment results before the meeting
- Pray over each person's top gifts and ask God how to activate them
- Print "The Hand of Christ" diagram if referencing five-fold ministry
- Be prepared to lay hands on disciples for impartation
- Create space for activation exercises (may need extra time)

Disciples:

- **COMPLETE THE SPIRITUAL GIFTS ASSESSMENT** before the meeting (link sent by your leader)
- Bring your assessment results (printed or on your phone)
- Come with an open heart to receive from the Father
- Be ready to activate your gifts during the session

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Meeting Structure (90 minutes)

1. Opening: The Father of Lights (10 minutes)

Leader opens:

"Tonight we're talking about spiritual gifts. But before we dive into what gifts you have, we need to establish something critical: **These gifts don't define you. They don't make you more loved. They don't determine your value.**

You are beloved FIRST. Gifted SECOND.

> ***James 1:17* says:** *'Every good thing given and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variation or shifting shadow.'*

God is the best Dad you've always wanted and never knew you had. And tonight, as beloved children, we're going to discover what gifts He's placed inside you—not for you, but for others. Not to puff you up, but to build up the Body.

Your gifts are for the **'common good.'** Everything God gives you is meant to be enjoyed by others."

Opening Prayer:

"Father, Thank You for being the Father of lights who gives good gifts. Tonight, help us receive what You've designed us to carry—not as orphans begging for validation, but as beloved children who boldly ask because we know who You are.

Show us how You've wired us. Unlock the gifts You've placed inside us. And help us use them to serve others, not ourselves. In Jesus' name."

2. Identity First: Gifts Don't Define You (10 minutes)

Leader teaches:

"Let's get something straight before we talk about your assessment results. **Your spiritual gifts are NOT your identity.** You are not:

- 'The prophetic one'
- 'The teacher'
- 'The mercy person'

You are a **beloved child of God** who happens to serve others through specific gifts.

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When we make our gifts our identity, here's what happens:

1. **Pride** – 'I'm more valuable because I have this gift'
2. **Comparison** – 'My gift is better/worse than theirs'
3. **Insecurity** – 'If I don't perform well, I'm worthless'
4. **Burnout** – 'I have to use this gift constantly to prove myself'

That's why we spent Week 10 establishing **who you are in Christ.** Your identity is secure. Your value is settled. Your acceptance is permanent. Now we can talk about gifts—because they flow FROM your identity, not TO your identity.

> *'Now there are varieties of gifts, but the same Spirit; and there are varieties of service, but the same Lord; and there are varieties of activities, but it is the same God who empowers them all in everyone. To each is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the common good.'* - **1 Corinthians 12:4-7**

Notice three things:

1. **Variety** – We all have different gifts (and that's by design)
2. **Same Source** – Same Spirit, same Lord, same God (no gift is superior)
3. **Common Good** – Your gifts are for OTHERS, not for you

Key safeguard statement:

> Your spiritual gifts reveal HOW you'll serve, not WHO you are. You are loved the same whether you score high in prophecy or administration, healing or hospitality.

Discussion Questions:

Before taking the assessment, what did you think 'spiritual gifts' meant?

Did you think some gifts were more valuable than others?

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3. Review Your Assessment Results (15 minutes)

The assessment measured three categories:

TIER 1: HOW YOU SERVE (Everyone has these)

- Romans 12 gifts: Teaching, serving, encouraging, giving, leading, mercy, prophecy
- These are your natural wiring—how God designed you to love people

TIER 2: SUPERNATURAL EMPOWERMENT (Gifts you grow into)

- 1 Corinthians 12 gifts: Wisdom, knowledge, faith, healing, miracles, prophecy, discernment, tongues, interpretation
- These are accessed through the Holy Spirit and activated through practice
- You might have high DESIRE but low EXPERIENCE—and that's perfect

TIER 3: LEADERSHIP CALLING (Some, not all)

- Ephesians 4 five-fold: Apostle, prophet, evangelist, shepherd, teacher
- Some people won't score high here—and that's God's perfect design
- The Body needs more servants than it needs leaders

Share your results

1. Share your top 2-3 gifts from Tier 1 (How You Serve)
2. Share 1-2 gifts from Tier 2 (Supernatural) that you DESIRE most
3. Your partner's job: 'I can totally see that in you because...'

This isn't just about the quiz—it's about confirmation. You're affirming what you've already observed in each other over the last 10 weeks."

4. One Body, Many Parts (10 minutes)

Now let's talk about why we need ALL the gifts represented here tonight.

> *Just as a body, though one, has many parts, but all its many parts form one body, so it is with Christ... If they were all one part, where would the body be? As it is, there are many parts, but one body.* - **1 Corinthians 12:12-20**

Paul is saying: **You are necessary.** Without you, the Body is incomplete.

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But here's the tension: We live in a culture that elevates certain gifts and ignores others.

- We celebrate the **teachers and preachers** (the public gifts)
- We overlook the **servants and mercy-givers** (the behind-the-scenes gifts)

But God doesn't operate that way. In His economy:

- The gift of **serving** is just as valuable as the gift of **prophecy**
- The gift of **mercy** is just as needed as the gift of **teaching**
- The gift of **administration** is just as important as the gift of **miracles**

We must learn to use our spiritual gifts so the Body can function effectively.

> **Verse 25-27:** *'...so that there should be no division in the body, but that its parts should have equal concern for each other. If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honored, every part rejoices with it. Now you are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it.'*

We are interconnected. When one person operates in their gift, we all benefit. When one person withholds their gift, we all suffer. It all comes down to these three words… **Play your part.**

5. Teaching: Understanding the Gifts (15 minutes)

Let me give you a quick overview of the gifts so you understand what you scored.

TIER 1: HOW YOU SERVE (Romans 12:6-8)

1. **Prophecy** – Hearing God's word and speaking truth (forthtelling, not just foretelling)
2. **Serving** – Meeting practical needs; you see what needs to be done and do it
3. **Teaching** – Taking complex truths and making them clear and applicable
4. **Encouraging** – Speaking life, hope, and strength into others
5. **Giving** – Generous with resources (time, money, skills); you see needs and meet them sacrificially
6. **Leadership** – Organizing people and resources toward a vision; you naturally take initiative
7. **Mercy** – Compassion in action; you feel others' pain and bring comfort

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TIER 2: SUPERNATURAL EMPOWERMENT (1 Corinthians 12:7-11)

1. **Word of Wisdom** – Knowing God's will and how to implement it
2. **Word of Knowledge** – Inside information about a person, place, or situation
3. **Faith** – Believing God for impossible situations
4. **Gifts of Healing** – Laying hands on the sick and seeing recovery
5. **Miracles** – Performing signs that create awe in witnesses
6. **Prophecy** – Hearing, seeing, and speaking God's rhema (now word)
7. **Discerning of Spirits** – Knowing what spirit is at work (Holy Spirit, human spirit, demonic)
8. **Tongues** – Speaking in unknown languages (earthly and heavenly)
9. **Interpretation of Tongues** – Hearing an unknown language and interpreting it

TIER 3: LEADERSHIP CALLING (Ephesians 4:11)

These are leadership offices in the Body, not everyone will score high here:

1. **Apostle** – Sent ones who build kingdom culture; they make earth look like heaven
2. **Prophet** – See and hear from heaven; they point the way and bring correction
3. **Evangelist** – Reach the lost; they extend past the four walls
4. **Shepherd/Pastor** – Care for the flock; married to the people
5. **Teacher** – Open the Scriptures and equip the saints

Character > Gifts:

These gifts can grow and change over time. You can operate in gifts that aren't your 'top scores' when needed.The fruit of the Spirit (love, joy, peace, patience) matters more than spiritual gifts without character.

6. Impartation & Activation (20 minutes)

Alright, we're not just going to LEARN about gifts tonight—we're going to ACTIVATE them.

> *For this reason I remind you to fan into flame the gift of God, which is in you through the laying on of my hands. For the Spirit God gave us does not make us timid, but gives us power, love and self-discipline. -* **2 Timothy 1:6-7**

Paul is saying: The gift is already in you. It just needs to be unlocked and fanned into flame.

Tonight, we're going to lay hands on you and pray for the gifts God has placed inside you. Then you're going to activate them IMMEDIATELY.

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We don't open a gift from God and say 'I'll play with that later.' It's time to play your part in the Body.

The Process:

1. **ACCESS** – Submit to the Holy Spirit
2. **ASK** – Ask boldly as beloved children (remember: you're not an orphan)
3. **ACTIVATE** – Use the gift immediately (don't wait)

ACTIVATION FORMAT:

- As the group lays hands on each person, the leader prays specifically for their top 2 gifts
- Immediately after prayer, that person uses the gift or plans to use the gift if preparation is needed (see exercises below)

ACTIVATION IDEAS YOU CAN USE

TIER 1: SERVING GIFTS

1. Teaching

- Give 2 minutes to explain one truth from Scripture you learned in the last 10 weeks
- Practice teaching a biblical concept to someone who doesn't know it

2. Serving/Helps

- Identify one practical need in the group right now and meet it
- Commit to one act of service for another group member this week

3. Encouraging

- Speak a word of encouragement over each person in your pair/small group
- Text an encouragement to someone outside this group tonight

4. Giving

- What resource (time, money, skill, possession) could you share with someone in need this week?
- Practice generosity: commit to one sacrificial gift

5. Leadership

- Lead the group in a specific activity (prayer, discussion, declaration)

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- Take ownership of organizing one aspect of next week's gathering

6. Mercy

- Who in your life is suffering right now? Pray for them and commit to reaching out
- Practice listening to someone without trying to fix—just presence and compassion

7. Prophecy (Romans 12 version)

- Speak truth from God's Word over someone's situation
- Declare who God says someone is (identity, calling, character)

TIER 2: SUPERNATURAL GIFTS

1. Word of Wisdom

- Ask God for specific direction for someone's decision or situation
- Practice: "I sense God is showing me..." about a situation someone shares

2. Word of Knowledge

- Ask God to reveal something you couldn't naturally know about someone
- Practice: "I'm seeing/sensing..." (could be a picture, word, feeling)

3. Faith

- What impossible situation needs breakthrough? Declare faith over it
- Practice believing God for something specific and bold right now

4. Gifts of Healing

- Lay hands on someone with physical pain or sickness
- Practice: "In Jesus' name, be healed"
- Follow up: "What are you feeling/experiencing?"

5. Miracles

- Pray for breakthrough in an impossible situation
- Practice declaring the impossible possible

6. Prophecy (1 Cor 12 version)

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- Ask God what He's saying to someone right now (a "now word")
- Practice: "I sense God is saying to you..."

7. Discerning of Spirits

- What spirit is at work in a situation? (Holy Spirit, human spirit, demonic)
- Practice: "I sense this is..." and test it with the group

8. Tongues

- Ask the Holy Spirit for your prayer language
- Practice: Open your mouth and let the Spirit give you words
- If you already have it: Use it to pray over someone

9. Interpretation of Tongues

- If someone prays in tongues, ask God what He's saying
- Practice: "I sense that means..."

IMPORTANT NOTES FOR LEADERS:

- Don't force anyone to activate a gift they're uncomfortable with
- Create a safe environment—no performance pressure
- Affirm every attempt, even if it feels "small"
- Remind them: We're learning. This is practice. Grace abounds.
- Some gifts (healing, miracles) may not show immediate results—that's okay, we're stepping out in faith

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7. Debrief & Closing (15 minutes)

Leader guides:

"Let's take a moment to process what just happened.

Debrief Questions:

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- What did you experience when you activated your gift?
- What felt natural? What felt stretching?
- Did anyone see or experience breakthrough? (healing, prophecy, encouragement, etc.)

Remember: Activation is just the beginning. Now you need to **practice.**

Just like any skill, spiritual gifts grow stronger with use. Don't put this gift on a shelf. Use it this week."

Challenge for the Week:

"This week, I'm challenging you to use your top gift to serve someone outside this group.

- If you have **mercy**, reach out to someone who's suffering
- If you have **encouragement**, send a text that speaks life
- If you have **teaching**, explain a biblical truth to someone
- If you have **prophecy**, ask God what He's saying to someone and share it
- If you have **serving**, meet a practical need without being asked

Pay attention to where you see fruit—that's confirmation."

Closing Prayer:

"Father, Thank You for what You've done tonight. You've revealed how You've designed each of us to serve. You've unlocked gifts that have been dormant. You've activated what's been waiting.

We seal this by the blood of Jesus. We declare that we are vessels of Your power—not for our glory, but for the 'common good' of the Body.

Help us steward these gifts well. Help us use them in love. Help us serve others the way You've served us.

Remind us: We are beloved first, gifted second. Our identity is in You, not in our function.

We worship You as the Father of lights, the giver of every good and perfect gift. In Jesus' name, Amen."

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Leader Notes & Tips

Common Pitfalls to Avoid:

1. **Don't let anyone make their gift their identity** – Constantly redirect to Christ
2. **Don't compare gifts** – All are equally valuable in God's economy
3. **Don't force activation** – Create space, but don't pressure
4. **Don't skip the impartation** – Laying on of hands is biblical and powerful

What to Watch For:

- Disciples who are hesitant to activate (fear of failure, fear of looking foolish)
- Disciples who over-spiritualize and miss the practical (administration, serving, helps)
- Disciples who want to skip to "big" gifts without character development

Red Flags:

- Someone claims to have ALL the gifts (pride or misunderstanding)
- Someone dismisses their gifts as "not important" (insecurity or false humility)
- Someone uses their gift to control or manipulate others (spiritual abuse)